

Sri Lanka Institute of Information Technology



Employability Skills Development

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Employability Readiness – Evidence-Based Reflection

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1. Introduction

In today's competitive job market, having only technical skills is not enough to succeed. Employers expect graduates to have a balance of technical knowledge, soft skills, and a professional attitude. In this assignment, I reflect on my own employability readiness based on my academic experiences over the past two years. By looking at real situations I have faced, evaluating my strengths and weaknesses, and connecting them with what I learned in lectures, I aim to understand how prepared I am for the IT industry. This reflection also helps me identify the areas I need to improve and create a clear plan to become more confident and job ready.

2. Evidence-Based Self-Reflection & Lecture Impact Analysis

However, during my second year, I faced a challenging situation while working on a group assignment for the ITP module. The assignment involved developing a MERN project within a certain period. I began with my assignment, but I underestimated the complexity of the requirements. I delayed implementing my assignment. Subsequently, I realized I had not completed some of the major functions, including error handling and appropriate structure for my code. I then hastened to finish my assignment, and what I came up with is a system that is already working but has a lot of bugs. I was able to finish my assignment, though it is not exactly what I wanted. I was able to get an average grade for my assignment. The experience is significant since it taught me my weakness in time management and professionalism.

This experience showed me that my level of preparation in terms of being “employability ready” is not only determined by my skill level, but also by how effectively I am able to manage time and pressure in a situation. In a real work environment, it might affect the productivity of work. When I am evaluating myself in terms of these characteristics, I would rate myself 3 out of 5 in terms of accountability because I completed my assignment and submitted it on time, but I did not plan well from the beginning. When it comes to communication, I would rate myself 3 out of 5 because it is a group assignment, but I did not seek assistance when I had difficulties with it, which is another important characteristic of a professional. When it comes to teamwork, I would rate myself 4 out of 5 according to my own experience, but I also need to be open to teamwork. When it comes to adaptability, I would rate myself 4 out of 5 because I was able to adapt and complete my assignment, but it is not perfect, but I also need to be careful not to rely on this characteristic. When it comes to professional discipline, I would rate myself 3 out of 5 because I did not manage my time well.

One lecture that strongly influenced me was about "Time Management and Professional Discipline". A key idea discussed was that "consist small progress is more effective than last-minute effort. “This concept challenged my habit of delaying tasks until the deadline approaches. After reflecting on this, I realized that professional success depends on consistency, planning, and early action. This lecture changes my mindset by making me understand that discipline is not just about meeting deadlines, but about maintaining quality and reliability throughout the process.

3. Industry Alignment & Professional Judgment

For this section, I have selected a job as a QA engineer in a software company. The skills required for this job are details, knowledge of testing tools, and communication skills. When it comes to my skills, I think my skill in detail is average because I fall into the moderate category in this area. When doing my academic assignments, I have come across some bugs and have been able to fix them, but at other times, I miss some details as I hurry up in completing my assignments. Knowledge of testing tools is basic because I lack knowledge of tools such as Selenium or any other automated testing framework that is required in this area. When it comes to communication skills, I think my skill in this area is average because I can communicate effectively, but I lack the required confidence in communication, especially in a team setting. As far as my communication skills are concerned, I would say that I am average in terms of having good communication skills, but I do not have enough confidence to communicate in an appropriate manner, especially in a group environment.

As far as the given ethical scenario is concerned, in the context where there is a critical bug to be fixed close to the deadline and the team lead is suggesting ignoring the bug for some time, I would prefer to fix the bug rather than ignoring the bug. This is because, if we deliver the software with a critical bug, it may lead to serious consequences for our company.

This is because I would be proving to myself that I value long-term relationships as opposed to short-term convenience. In a way, I would be playing an ethical role. I know what the right thing to do is, but I don't have the confidence to convince the authority of the same.

4. My Immediate Upgrade Plan

In order to improve my employability readiness, I have planned the following strategies which I aim to implement over the next six months. Firstly, I plan to undertake a course on software testing as well as practice the use of tools such as selenium to design a project. This would help me to upgrade my skills, especially my quality assurance skills.

Secondly, I plan to upgrade my skills in the use of time management using a weekly planning system. This would assist me in avoiding working under pressure, and at the same time, upgrade my discipline.

Finally, I want to focus on improving my ability to work effectively in group settings, especially by becoming more confident in sharing my ideas with others. To achieve this, I plan to take part in at least two group projects where I can actively contribute and take on a coordinating role. By doing this, I hope to strengthen my communication skills, become more comfortable collaborating with others, and gradually overcome my current weakness. This experience will also help me better prepare for working in a professional team environment.

5. Conclusion

In conclusion, this reflection has helped me better understand where I currently stand in terms of employability and what I need to improve. Although I have built a good foundation in technical skills, I realize that I still need to work on areas like communication, teamwork and professional discipline. The lessons I have learned from both my experiences and lectures have encouraged me to take more responsibility and focus on improving myself continuously. By following my upgrade plan and working on my weakness step by step, I believe I can become more prepared and confident to enter the professional IT Environment.